# Game film and book production

## Purpose and main finding

This reference follows the completed animation research into three related production systems. A game delivers interactive behavior; a movie delivers an ordered audiovisual experience; a book delivers edited content in one or more reading formats. They can share planning and review records, but cannot share a single undifferentiated completion test.

## Scope

The following pages cover development, production, review, delivery and preservation. They are practical research synthesis, not a universal studio sequence. Small teams combine roles, specialists work in parallel, and revision can return work to earlier stages. Marketing, accessibility, rights and preservation planning begin before release.

## Status

Research checked 22 October 2026. This new media reference remains a candidate. The prior animation reference is ratified according to the supplied task context; that does not ratify these additions. Nothing here authorizes purchasing, human testing, physical production, publication, live changes or canonical synchronization.

## Reading map

Pages 2 and 3 cover games. Pages 4 and 5 cover live-action movie production and its differences from animation. Pages 6 and 7 cover books. Page 8 compares shared controls through a nonfantasy example. Page 9 records the bounded review. Pages 10 and 11 provide primary sources.

## How to use the reference

Start with the intended output and its acceptance evidence. Assign ownership of inputs and review decisions. Preserve the source version, note uncertainty, and separate reviewed from approved and released. A successful export, a polished demo or a clean-looking page is evidence of a limited result, not proof that the entire production is ready.

# Game development and production

## Concept and scope

A designer, writer and producer define the audience, repeated player activity, intended experience, target platforms and constraints. The handoff is a short concept brief and an assumptions list. Describe what the player does, not only the fictional setting. Establish what the initial release excludes.

## Prototype and representative slice

A prototype cheaply tests a specific mechanic, control scheme or technical assumption. Record its question and what it actually demonstrates. A representative slice combines a small section of gameplay, assets, interface and sound at intended quality. Its value includes evidence about integration and production effort. A promotional demo may be polished without proving that the full project can be produced sustainably.

## Preproduction

Design and technical leads define architecture, level structure, asset specifications, interface conventions and dependencies. Production planning assigns owners, milestones and budget constraints. Establish version control, build naming and change review. Keep unresolved feasibility questions visible rather than hiding them inside a detailed schedule.

## Production and integration

Programmers implement systems while designers, artists, animators, writers and audio staff create content. Their handoff is not merely a folder of finished source files: it is content that works in an identified executable build. Review timing, scale, collision, interface and audio behavior in context. ScreenSkills documents the breadth of these roles [G1].

## Handoff example

For a train-station mystery, the writer supplies dialogue with speaker and context; design supplies interaction conditions; art supplies the locker and its states; programming implements opening and persistence; audio supplies feedback. The acceptance case is a correctly behaving interaction, not five individually approved files. These role assignments are illustrative, not a prescribed staffing model.

# Game testing release and maintenance

## Different questions need different evidence

Functional testing checks controls, progression, inventory, collision and save/load. Experience review asks whether the activity is understandable and worthwhile. Technical checks cover supported devices, crashes, loading and frame-time behavior. Accessibility and localization assess barriers not answered by ordinary defect testing. ScreenSkills distinguishes reporting reproducible defects from retesting fixes [G2].

## Accessibility and localization

Microsoft presents its Xbox Accessibility Guidelines as design ideas, development guardrails and testing checklists [G3]. They are not a blanket certification. Consider readable text, input options and alternatives to color-only or sound-only information. Localization includes context, text expansion, fonts, directionality and locale-dependent assets; Godot documents these mechanisms [G5]. No participant playtest was performed for this reference.

## Build and release

An editable project is not the same as a distributable package. Record the engine/tool versions, export preset, target and included dependencies. Godot provides one concrete export workflow [G4]. Test clean installation and the actual release candidate. Steam separately reviews store preparation and game-build preparation [G6]; other platforms require their own checks. Store approval does not replace comprehensive QA or the user's deployment authorization.

## Maintenance and preservation

Plan defect triage, regression tests, compatibility updates, save migration and recovery from a bad release where supported. Service games additionally need operational ownership and an eventual retirement plan. Preserve source, build outputs, licenses and dependency information. A repository alone may not reconstruct a service-dependent game.

## A useful counterexample

A cinematic shows the detective opening the correct locker. A player may instead try the wrong locker, leave, save midway, change language or return later. Each permitted route creates state and feedback requirements. The cinematic can be correct while the game still loses a clue or blocks progression. A proposed release gate must name the tested state cases and remaining exclusions.

# Movie planning and capture

## What live action adds

The animation reference supplies related story, editorial and finishing concepts. Live action adds dependencies on performers, locations, equipment, weather and physical capture. Production planning must coordinate creative intention with the circumstances under which usable material can be recorded. A script is not evidence that the necessary coverage exists.

## Development and breakdown

Writer, director and producer establish story, scope, audience and feasible approach. A scene breakdown identifies cast, locations, props, costumes, effects, sound and logistics. Production management turns those dependencies into budgets and schedules; ScreenSkills describes its organizational responsibilities [F1]. Shooting order can differ from story order.

## Preproduction and readiness

Casting, rehearsals, location work, production design, cinematography, sound planning and coverage decisions produce department briefs and working plans. Permissions and rights issues need accountable review. Call sheets communicate daily arrangements; they do not themselves prove that risk controls or resources are adequate. Physical activity remains outside this research authorization.

## Safety boundary

Appropriately qualified and accountable personnel must assess actual production conditions. HSE provides film and broadcasting safety guidance for the UK [F3]. Its jurisdiction must not be generalized to every country, and this document is not individualized legal or safety advice. No stunt, hazardous setup or participant experiment is proposed as an authorized next action.

## Capture and media handoff

Camera, lighting, sound, performance and continuity work must produce identifiable, usable material. Preserve camera and sound identifiers, reports and continuity notes. Verify transfers and retain originals. Editorial needs usable focus, exposure, sound and coverage, not merely a successful recording indicator. A restaurant drama can fail editorially if the crucial reaction was never captured or the quiet accusation is unusable under background noise.

# Movie editorial finishing and delivery

## Dailies and assembly

Editors can assemble material while shooting continues, allowing missing coverage to be identified while it may still be recoverable. ScreenSkills notes that footage is commonly captured out of story order [F2]. Dailies may use proxies, temporary color or temporary sound; their appearance is not necessarily the final image or mix.

## Cut development and turnovers

Director and editor shape performance, pacing and story. VFX, music, dialogue editing and sound design may overlap this work. Each turnover should identify the cut version, timebase, source references and intended changes. Picture lock is a coordination boundary: later changes still require impact review and new turnovers where necessary.

## Finishing

Conform reconnects the edit to appropriate source material. Color, final VFX, sound mix, titles and access materials must match the intended version. Review the finished master from start to end. Creative approval and technical compliance are different decisions: the right story can still have missing subtitles, incorrect channels or mismatched credits.

## Delivery depends on destination

Confirm actual distributor, broadcaster, platform or festival specifications rather than assuming one master satisfies every outlet. The BFI and Film4 Future Takes scheme, for example, explicitly requires subtitles and audio description alongside other delivery materials [F4]. That is an example of a particular commissioning requirement, not a universal rule for every movie.

## Preservation and revision

Retain approved masters, essential source elements, metadata and rights/credit records. BFI describes technical and descriptive cataloguing as part of archival acquisition [F5]. A backup copy without identity or context is not a complete preservation strategy. If the restaurant scene is shortened, recheck music, dialogue edits, captions, audio description and delivery duration rather than approving only the new picture cut.

# Book development and editorial production

## Publishing responsibility

Traditional publishers may coordinate editorial, design, production, sales and publicity; self-publishers retain or commission those responsibilities. Penguin describes these distinct functions [B1]. The route changes who performs the work, not whether the output needs careful review. Publisher acceptance and self-publication are not quality tests by themselves.

## Concept research and draft

Define readership, purpose, genre and scope. Preserve research notes and uncertainty. Develop a structure or narrative and a versioned manuscript. For nonfiction, identify claims needing verification; for fiction, track narrative and character consistency. Neither a polished sentence nor an attractive cover resolves a structural omission.

## Developmental editing

Author and editor examine organization, argument, pacing, character development and missing material. The handoff can include an editorial report, revision plan and revised manuscript. Penguin distinguishes structural editorial work from later editorial-production coordination [B2]. Revisions may be iterative rather than a single pass.

## Copyediting

An agreed brief covers language-level clarity and consistency, queries and a style sheet. CIEP distinguishes copyediting from proofreading and cautions against assuming that it includes substantial research, obtaining permissions or resolving legal problems [B3]. Assign fact verification and permissions explicitly when needed.

## Design and proofreading

Designers and production staff create cover and interior treatments for the relevant formats. Proofreading checks edited content in its final layout, including placement and consistency. Major structural rewriting at proof stage can invalidate layout and downstream checks. A gardening handbook may be grammatically clean while omitting the explanation that makes a diagram usable; editorial review and design review must both address that problem.

# Book formats distribution and corrections

## Print and digital are different outputs

Print review considers trim, margins, pagination, running heads, illustrations and physical output. Reflowable EPUB review considers semantic structure, reading order, navigation, resizing and appropriate image alternatives. One approved print PDF does not establish a usable EPUB. W3C EPUB Accessibility 1.1 covers content accessibility and discoverability metadata [B4]. Automated validation is useful but does not answer every reader-experience question.

## Metadata and identifiers

Keep title, author, edition and format information consistent across files and listings. The International ISBN Agency explains separate identification of relevant product forms and editions [B5]. An ISBN is not a quality award or proof of ownership. Platform rules are separate: KDP does not require an ISBN for its ebooks, and its free print ISBN has platform restrictions [B6].

## Proofs and delivery

Preview converted files and check the actual outputs, not a single screenshot. KDP supplies upload and preview workflows and requires relevant metadata to match the book [B7]. Physical proofs can reveal print problems that a screen does not. Acceptance by a distribution system establishes a limited technical result, not universal reading quality.

## Manufacture and distribution

Print on demand supports producing copies in response to orders. Distribution makes titles available through channels; it does not guarantee purchases or shelf placement. IngramSpark describes its print and ebook distribution service [B8]. Prices, contractual terms, returns and channel requirements need current project-specific checking before any commercial commitment.

## Corrections and archive

Maintain an errata record, corrected outputs and clear edition/version identity. Review whether changes affect pagination, index entries, cross-references, citations and accessibility. Substantial revisions may require a new edition identifier under applicable ISBN guidance. Preserve manuscripts, layouts, digital packages, source assets and relevant permissions. No purchase, ISBN application or publication was performed.

# Shared controls and a cross media example

## A common production record

For each deliverable, record purpose, audience, owner, reviewer, version identity, inputs, dependencies, rights evidence, acceptance criteria, findings and uncertainty. Distinguish draft, reviewed, ratified and released. Record changes and the checks they invalidate. These are candidate controls for consideration, not adopted Blackwish policy.

## What cannot be transferred unchanged

Game continuity includes persistent states and player consequences. Movie continuity includes performance, action and shot relationships. Book continuity includes narrative, factual and terminology consistency. Accessibility likewise differs: interaction barriers in games, audiovisual access versions in film, and reading structure and navigation in books. A shared heading is not a shared test procedure.

## One contemporary mystery

A railway employee discovers that a lost-property receipt contradicts a passenger's account. In a game, the receipt must remain available under permitted investigation routes and save states. In a film, coverage, performance and edit order must let the viewer notice the contradiction. In a novel, wording, viewpoint and the timing of disclosure must make the clue fair and intelligible. This is a hypothetical text-only example, not an audience experiment.

## One revision with three consequences

Changing the receipt's date may alter a game condition and localized interface text. It may require a movie prop replacement or VFX correction plus dialogue/subtitle changes. It may alter a book's timeline and cross-references. The source edit is small, but the dependent artifacts differ. An impact record should follow actual dependencies rather than the apparent length of the edit.

## Minimum handoff question

What precisely is being handed over, to whom, at which version, with which unresolved issues, and what evidence lets the recipient accept it? If the answer is only “the final file,” the handoff is underspecified. The appropriate stopping condition is an accepted scope and documented remaining uncertainty, not an unsupported claim that all production risks have disappeared.

# Bounded compatibility and review

## Selected history compatibility

This review is limited to the supplied user request for game, movie and book production after animation; the request to include nonfantasy genres; the authorization for text-only consistency exploration; and the instruction to keep research, review, ratification and deployment separate. Source-preserving successors and a text-first engine remain the supplied compatibility boundaries; no automatic visual branch is adopted. This is not a fullcanon, Wall of Shame or recurrence audit. No conflict was identified within that bounded scope.

## Zen lens one media specific evidence

POINT: distinguish what completion means in each medium. BRIDGE: primary role, platform and standard sources support the distinctions. PATH: require output-specific checks instead of inheriting animation approval. SHADOW: a polished demo, playable export or clean proof can conceal untested cases. Result: separate evidence requirements retained.

## Zen lens two revision handoffs

POINT: prevent a source change from silently invalidating downstream work. BRIDGE: versioned artifacts and explicit turnover identity connect cause and effect. PATH: trace changed inputs to affected outputs and re-review only the relevant dependent scope. SHADOW: small text changes can have large timing, state or pagination effects. Result: cross-media receipt example exposes this failure mode without changing live systems.

## Zen lens three rights accessibility and closure

POINT: keep permission, usability and release decisions distinct. BRIDGE: applicable sources describe specific requirements, not blanket authority. PATH: retain unresolved rights/access questions and stop before purchases, human tests, publication or deployment. SHADOW: platform acceptance does not prove rights clearance or complete accessibility. Result: delivery and authorization boundaries remain explicit.

## DK counterexample challenge

Could approval of the animation reference silently authorize a game build or visual branch? No. Could a small source edit preserve every downstream output? No. Could platform acceptance prove rights and accessibility? No. The candidate survives only with separate authority, impact review and media-specific evidence. DK here means this bounded contradiction challenge, not empirical certification.

## Meaning and limits of this review

POINT, BRIDGE, PATH and SHADOW are operational glosses here: objective; evidence and authority; consequences, alternatives and stopping; assumptions and counterexamples. They are not represented as an exact restatement of the full canon. All proposed applications remain candidates. Source coverage supports a broad reference, not a guarantee that every specialist process has been enumerated.

# Primary sources for games and movies

Links checked during research on 22 October 2026. These primary sources support the identified factual distinctions. The workflow synthesis and hypothetical examples are analytical proposals, not direct quotations.

**G1** ScreenSkills games roles

**G2** ScreenSkills games tester

**G3** Microsoft Xbox Accessibility Guidelines

**G4** Godot stable exporting projects

**G5** Godot 4.4 internationalizing games

**G6** Steamworks release process

**F1** ScreenSkills production manager

**F2** ScreenSkills editor

**F3** HSE film and broadcasting safety

**F4** BFI and Film4 Future Takes

**F5** BFI archival acquisition

# Primary sources for books

Links checked during research on 22 October 2026. These primary sources support the identified factual distinctions. The workflow synthesis and hypothetical examples are analytical proposals, not direct quotations.

**B1** Penguin publisher functions

**B2** Penguin editorial roles

**B3** CIEP proofreading and copyediting

**B4** W3C EPUB Accessibility 1.1

**B5** International ISBN Agency assignment

**B6** KDP ISBN guidance

**B7** KDP upload and preview

**B8** IngramSpark distribution

## Evidence limits

Godot G5 is explicitly version 4.4, not a claim about the newest release. HSE guidance is UK-specific. BFI F4 is a particular funding scheme. KDP, Steam and IngramSpark describe their own services. W3C B4 is EPUB Accessibility 1.1, published as a Recommendation on 17 October 2024. No software version, pricing or legal conclusion is generalized beyond the cited scope.